



KALASH

DESCENDANTS OF THE ANCIENT GREEKS

AROUND 4,000 KALASH PEOPLE LIVE IN CHITRAL, northwest Pakistan. They maintain that they are descended from Alexander the Great, who passed through the area around 400 BC, and that this is why

Valley people

As well as cultivating corn, wheat, and millet on the mountain terraces, and tending to their fruit trees, the Kalash also keep sheep and goats. While the milk is a valuable part of their diet, goats are important for another reason—they are sacrificed, sometimes in large numbers, on many of the festivals that punctuate the Kalash year.



HOME SWEET HOME

Houses are built out of local wood and stone and normally have two floors and a balcony. The ground floor is used to store grain or to shelter cattle, while people live on the upper floor. A fireplace in this room provides heat and somewhere to cook but also creates a lot of soot. During the summer, people cook and sleep on the balcony.

GOING TO SCHOOL

Kalash children in the remote valleys travel very far to get to school. Because government schools are Muslim, they are taught about Islam in an attempt to convert them.